

PHASE 9 — CRYPTOGRAPHIC KNOWLEDGE GRAPH & ENTERPRISE RELATIONSHIP MODEL

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1. Purpose of This Phase

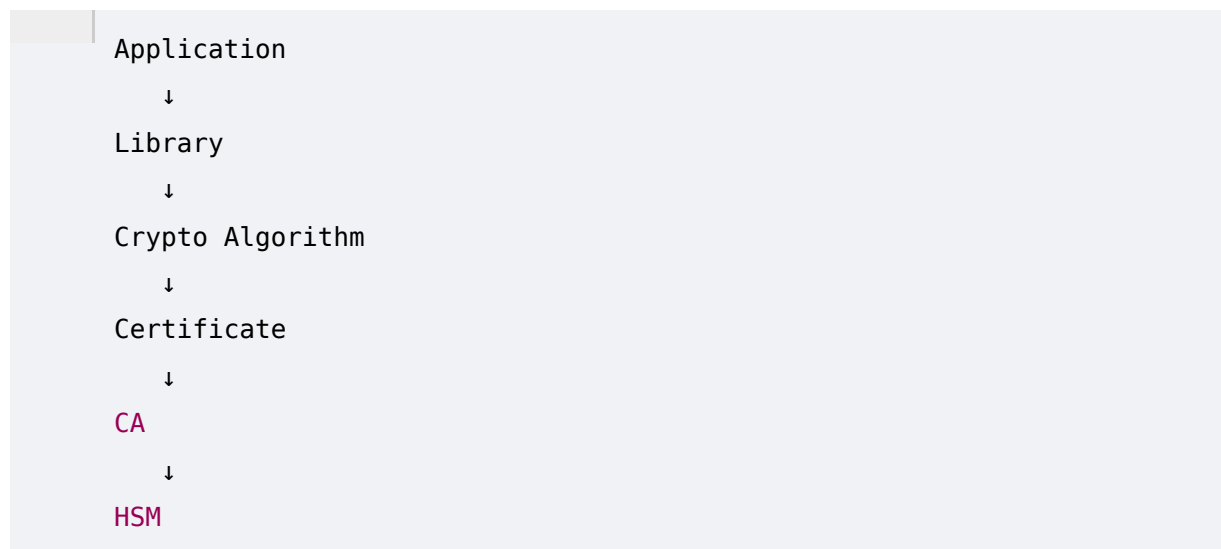
The previous phases built the core intelligence pipeline:



At this point ECDAT can discover individual cryptographic assets.

But an enterprise rarely has isolated assets.

Instead:



and:

```
Application
  ↓
API
  ↓
Database
  ↓
Sensitive Data
```

and:

```
Application
  ↓
Business Process
  ↓
Business Unit
  ↓
Owner
```

Everything is connected.

This phase designs the system that understands those relationships.

The Cryptographic Knowledge Graph.

2. Why a Knowledge Graph?

A traditional inventory might say:

```
RSA-2048
Used in:
Application A
Application B
Application C
```

A graph can say:

```
RSA-2048
|
├─ used by → Application A
|           └─ serves → Payment Processing
|
├─ used by → Application B
|           └─ protects → Customer Data
```

```
|
└─ used by → Application C
      └─ certificate signed by → CA-01
```

The second representation contains **relationships**, not just records.

This allows ECDAT to answer questions that an ordinary inventory struggles with.

3. From Inventory to Relationships

The fundamental evolution is:

```
Inventory
  ↓
Relationships
  ↓
Context
  ↓
Impact
  ↓
Intelligence
```

For example:

```
"RSA-2048 exists"
```

is useful.

But:

```
"RSA-2048 is used by 73 critical applications,
including the payment gateway and certificate
infrastructure, and migration is blocked by
a shared HSM dependency."
```

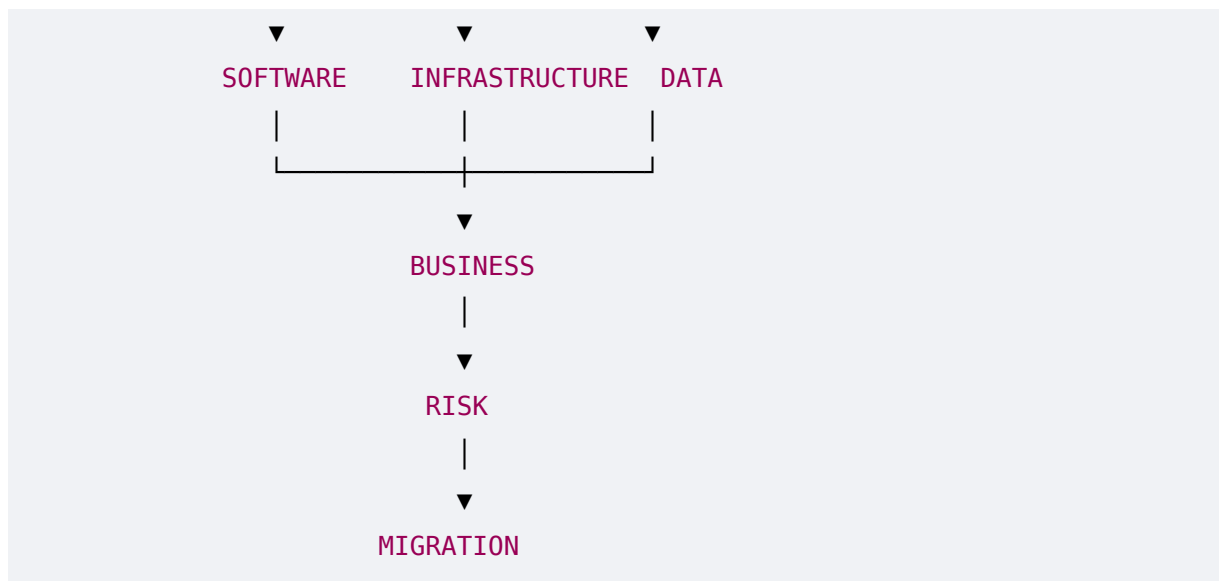
is much more valuable.

4. The ECDAT Intelligence Model

The graph should connect five major domains:

```
CRYPTOGRAPHY
```





This allows technical discoveries to be connected to business consequences.

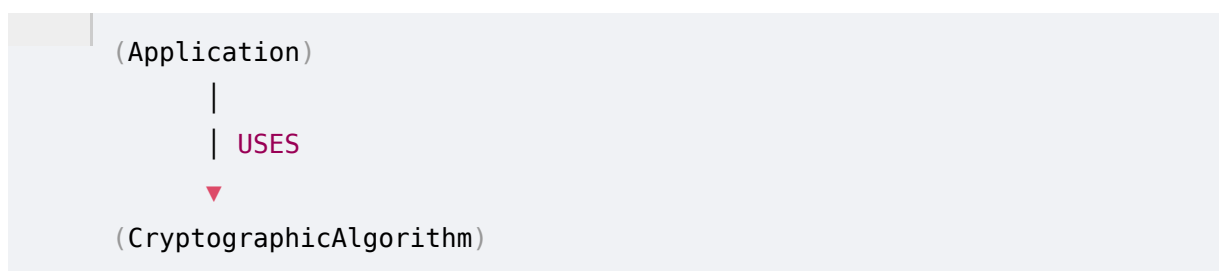
5. Graph Fundamentals

ECDAT can use a **property graph** model.

The basic components are:

- Node
- Relationship
- Property
- Evidence

Example:



Each node and relationship can contain metadata.

6. Nodes

A node represents an entity.

Examples:

- Application
- Repository

```
SourceFile
Function
Library
Algorithm
Key
Certificate
CA
Protocol
Container
Server
HSM
CloudService
DataAsset
BusinessProcess
Owner
```

7. Relationships

Relationships explain how entities interact.

Examples:

```
USES
DEPENDS_ON
CONTAINS
PROTECTS
SIGNED_BY
ISSUED_BY
STORED_IN
RUNS_ON
CALLS
IMPLEMENTS
DEPLOYED_TO
OWNED_BY
AFFECTS
REQUIRES
RECOMMENDS
MIGRATES_TO
```

8. Applications

Application nodes should contain:


```
Application ID
Name
Version
Environment
Criticality
Owner
Business Unit
Technology
Deployment
```

Example:

```
Application:
Payment Gateway

Criticality:
Mission Critical

Environment:
Production
```

9. Repositories

A repository represents a source-code project.

Properties:

```
Repository URL
Branch
Commit
Language
Owner
Last Scan
Visibility
```

Relationship:

```
Repository
|
└─ CONTAINS
    ↓
    SourceFile
```

10. Source Files

A source file can contain:

```
Path
Language
Hash
Repository
Commit
```

Example:

```
src/security/encryption.py
```

Relationships:

```
SourceFile
  ↓
DEFINES
  ↓
Function
```

11. Functions

Functions are important because cryptographic operations frequently occur at function level.

Example:

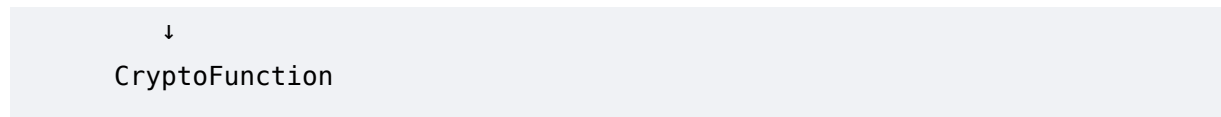
```
encrypt_customer_data()
```

Properties:

```
Name
File
Line
Language
Signature
```

Relationships:

```
Function
  ↓
CALLS
```



12. Libraries

Library nodes represent dependencies.

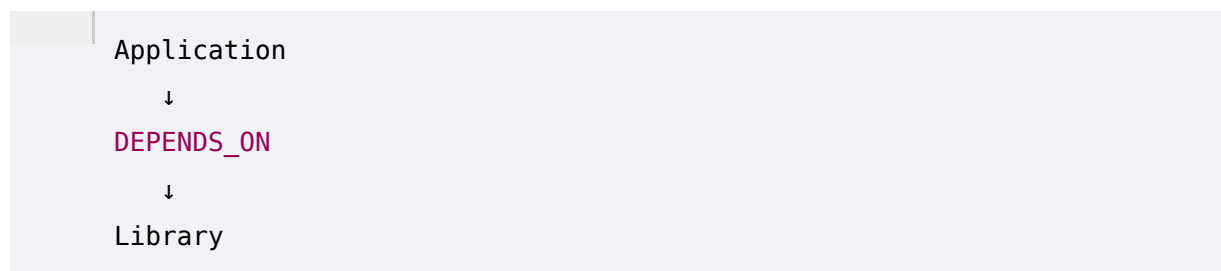
Example:

```
OpenSSL
Bouncy Castle
libsodium
PyCA Cryptography
```

Properties:

```
Name
Version
Package Manager
License
Source
```

Relationships:



13. Cryptographic Algorithms

This is one of the central node types.

Examples:

```
RSA
ECDSA
ECDH
AES
ChaCha20
SHA-256
ML-KEM
```

ML-DSA
SLH-DSA

Properties:

Family
Function
Key Size
Security Status
Quantum Status
Standard
Lifecycle

14. Keys

Key nodes can represent metadata about keys without exposing the secret material.

Example:

Key ID
Key Type
Algorithm
Size
Purpose
Location
Rotation Policy
Owner

Important:

ECDAT should generally inventory key metadata, not extract private key material.

15. Certificates

Certificate nodes can contain:

Subject
Issuer
Serial
Algorithm
Public Key Type
Validity

SANs
Key Usage
Environment

Relationships:

```
Certificate
|
|— USES → Algorithm
|— ISSUED_BY → CA
|— PROTECTS → Application
```

16. Certificate Authorities

CA nodes represent trust infrastructure.

Example:

```
Root CA
Intermediate CA
Issuing CA
```

Relationships:

```
Root CA
  ↓
ISSUES
  ↓
Intermediate CA
  ↓
ISSUES
  ↓
Certificate
```

This creates a PKI trust graph.

17. Protocols

Protocol nodes include:

```
TLS
IPsec
SSH
```

S/MIME

Kerberos

Application-specific protocols

Properties:

Version

Configuration

Cipher Suites

Key Exchange

Authentication

18. Containers

Container nodes:

Image

Tag

Digest

Base Image

Packages

Libraries

Relationships:

Container

↓

CONTAINS

↓

Library

This allows ECDAT to discover crypto embedded in container images.

19. Infrastructure

Infrastructure nodes include:

Server

VM

Cluster

Network Appliance

Load Balancer

Firewall
Gateway

Relationships:

Application
↓
DEPLOYED_ON
↓
Infrastructure

20. Cloud Services

Cloud nodes could represent:

KMS
HSM
Certificate Service
Load Balancer
API Gateway
Managed Database
Container Service

Example:

Application
↓
USES
↓
Cloud **KMS**

21. HSMs

HSMs deserve special treatment.

An HSM may support:

Key Storage
Signing
Encryption
Certificate Operations
Key Generation

Graph:

```
HSM
|
├── STORES → Key
├── USED_BY → Application
└── SUPPORTS → Algorithm
```

22. Data Assets

Data nodes represent information being protected.

Examples:

```
Customer Data
Government Records
Financial Data
Credentials
Intellectual Property
Strategic Information
```

Properties:

```
Sensitivity
Retention
Classification
Owner
Location
```

23. Business Processes

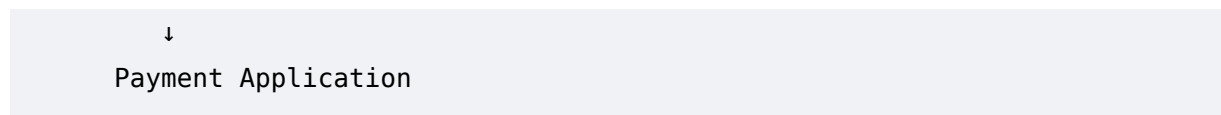
This is where technical security connects to business.

Example:

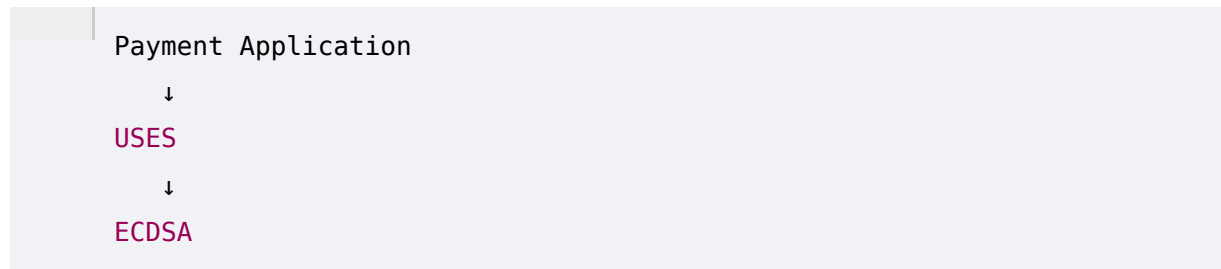
```
Business Process:
Online Payment Processing
```

Relationships:

```
Business Process
↓
DEPENDS_ON
```

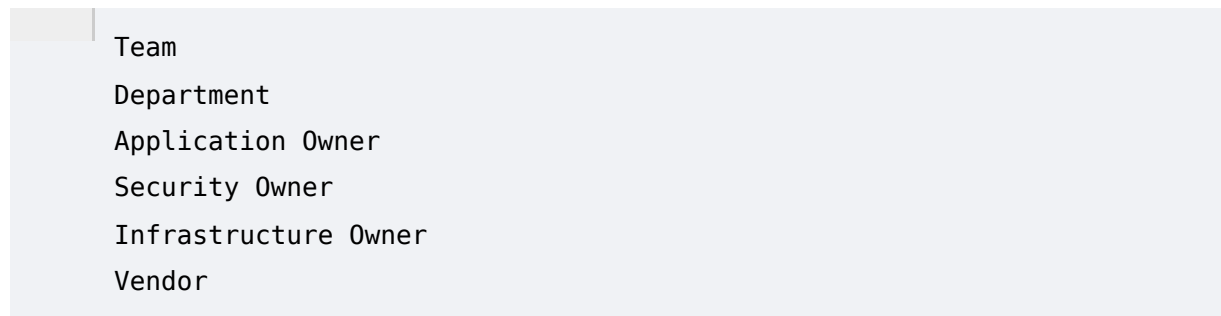
Then:



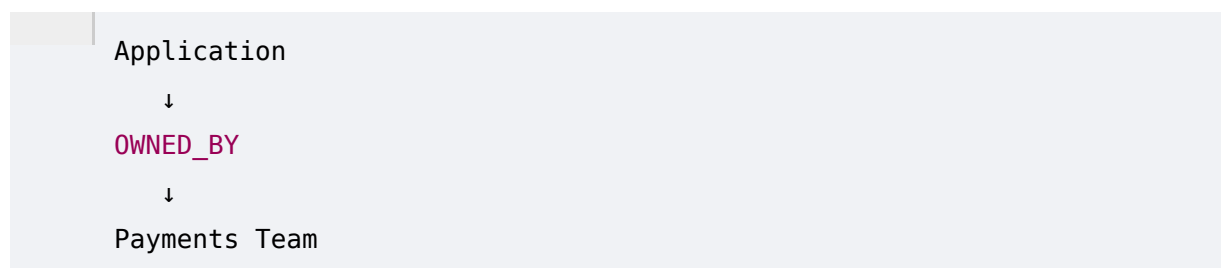
Now cryptographic risk can propagate into business context.

24. Owners

Owner nodes can represent:



Example:

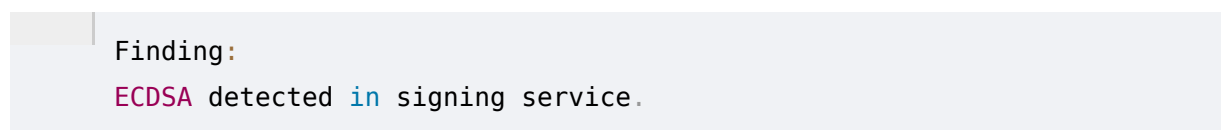


This enables accountability.

25. Findings

A finding represents an observation.

Example:



Properties:

```
Severity
Confidence
Evidence
Scanner
Timestamp
Status
```

26. Risks

Risk nodes represent assessed risk.

Example:

```
Risk:
Critical Quantum Exposure
```

Relationships:

```
Risk
  ↓
AFFECTS
  ↓
Application
```

27. Recommendations

Recommendation nodes capture decisions.

Example:

```
Recommendation:
Migrate ECDSA → ML-DSA
```

Properties:

```
Algorithm
Reason
Confidence
Constraints
Status
Created
```

28. Migration Plans

A migration plan describes:

```
Current State
Target State
Dependencies
Sequence
Timeline
Owner
Status
```

Graph:

```
Legacy Algorithm
  ↓
MIGRATES_TO
  ↓
PQC Algorithm
```

29. Node Metadata

Every important node should contain:

```
id
type
name
source
confidence
created_at
updated_at
environment
classification
```

Example:

```
{
  "id": "crypto-00123",
  "type": "algorithm",
  "name": "ECDSA",
  "confidence": 0.98,
```

```
"source": "static-analysis"  
}
```

30. Relationship Metadata

Relationships also need metadata.

Example:

```
Application  
|  
| USES  
|  
ECDSA
```

Relationship properties:

```
Evidence  
Confidence  
Source  
First Seen  
Last Seen  
Environment
```

This matters because relationships can change.

31. Evidence Graph

Every important graph relationship should be backed by evidence.

Example:

```
Application A  
|  
| USES  
|  
ECDSA
```

Evidence:

```
src/signing/service.py:42
```

Another relationship:

```
Application A
  |
  | DEPENDS_ON
  |
OpenSSL
```

Evidence:

```
container manifest
```

This makes the graph auditable.

32. Dependency Graph

A dependency graph might look like:

```
Application
  ↓
Framework
  ↓
Crypto Library
  ↓
OpenSSL
  ↓
Algorithm
```

This allows ECDAT to identify indirect cryptographic dependencies.

33. Cryptographic Usage Graph

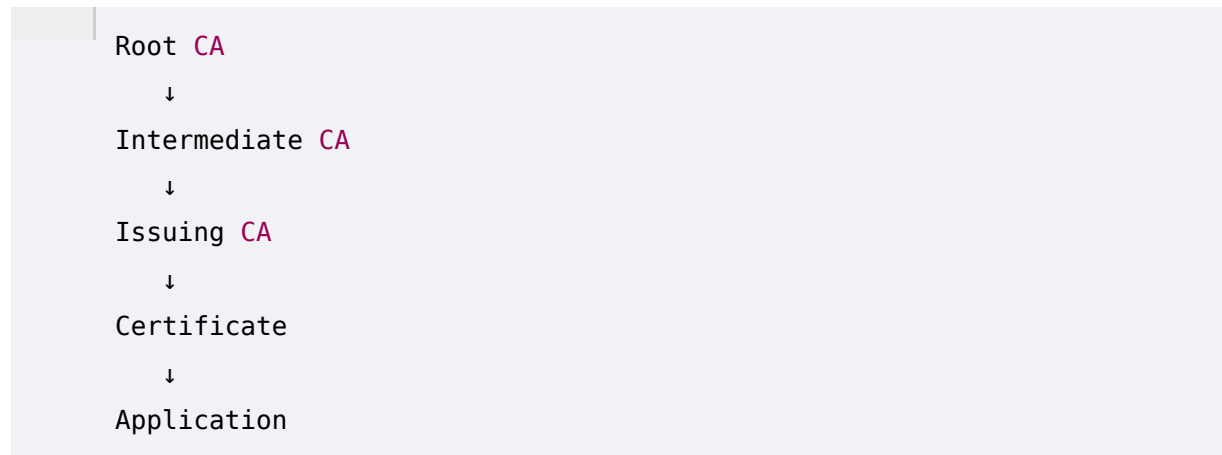
Example:

```
Application
  ↓
Function
  ↓
Crypto API
  ↓
Library
  ↓
Algorithm
```

This gives technical provenance.

34. PKI Trust Graph

Example:

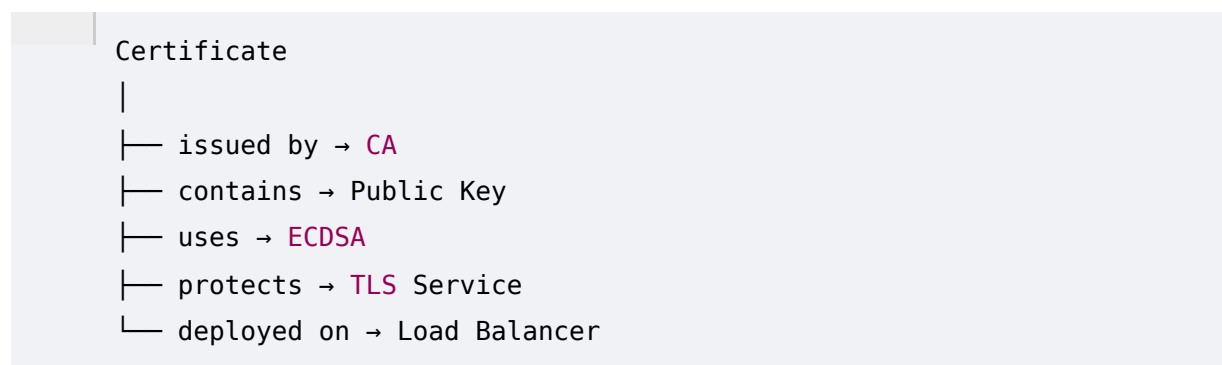


ECDAT can answer:

Which applications depend on this CA?

35. Certificate Graph

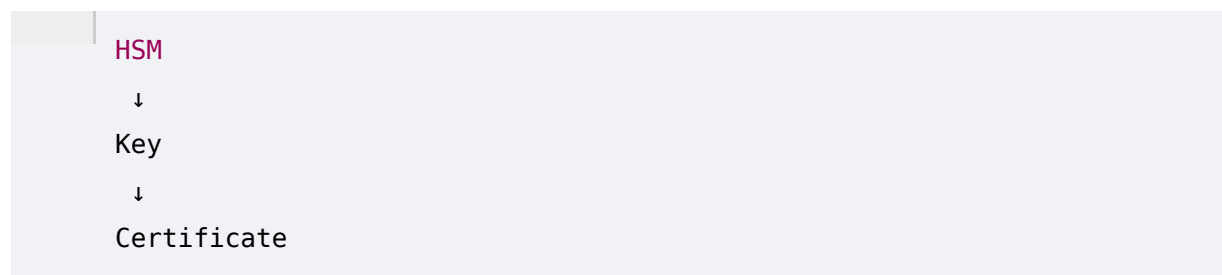
Consider:



Now certificate risk becomes contextual.

36. Key Dependency Graph

Example:



↓
Application
↓
Business Process

If the key becomes unavailable:

Business Process
↑
Application
↑
Certificate
↑
Key
↑
HSM

ECDAT can calculate the blast radius.

37. Application-to-Crypto Graph

Example:

Payment API
|
├─ TLS → ECDSA
├─ Database → AES
├─ Signing → RSA
└─ Token → HMAC

Now ECDAT can produce a complete cryptographic profile of the application.

38. Data-to-Crypto Graph

Example:

Customer Records
↓
Database
↓
AES-256-GCM
↓
Encryption Key

↓
HSM

This allows the question:

What cryptography protects this data?

39. Business-to-Crypto Graph

This is where ECDAT becomes strategically powerful.

Example:

Online Payments

↓

Payment Gateway

↓

TLS

↓

ECDSA

↓

Certificate

↓

CA

If ECDSA requires migration:

Business Process

↓

Migration Requirement

Now leadership can see why the cryptographic issue matters.

40. Risk Propagation

Suppose:

RSA

↓

Certificate

↓

Payment API

↓
Payment Processing

If RSA receives:

Risk = HIGH

ECDAT can propagate the implication.

Not:

Payment Processing = HIGH

automatically.

Instead:

Potential Business Impact:
High

Reason:
Dependency chain from RSA
to payment processing.

The system must distinguish direct risk from propagated impact.

41. Blast Radius

One of the most useful graph features:

Blast Radius Analysis

Select:

RSA-2048

ECDAT returns:

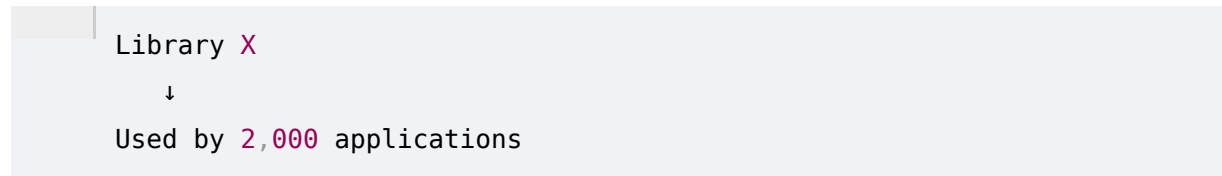
73 Applications
18 Certificates
4 CAs
2 Business Processes
3 HSM Dependencies

This is much more actionable than a flat inventory.

42. Centrality

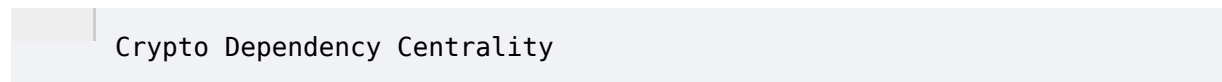
Graph centrality identifies highly connected cryptographic components.

Example:

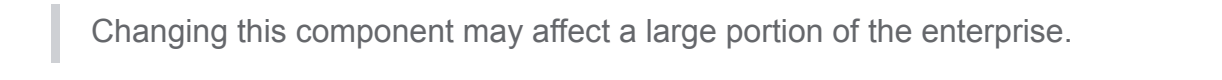


That library becomes a strategic migration priority.

Potential metric:

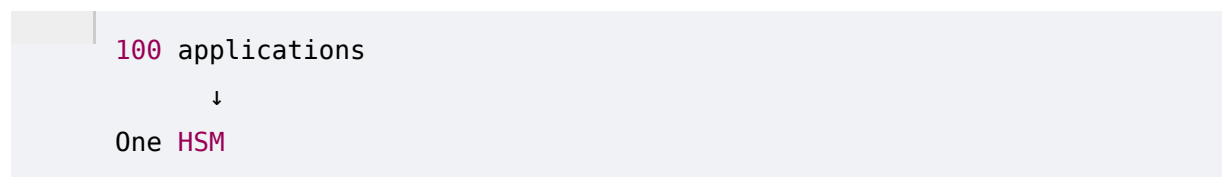


High centrality means:

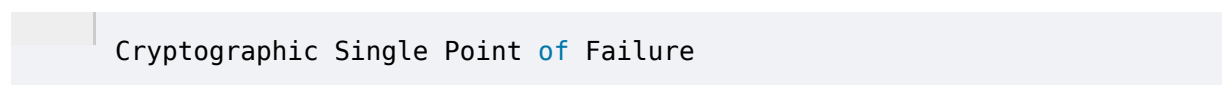


43. Single Points of Failure

Suppose:

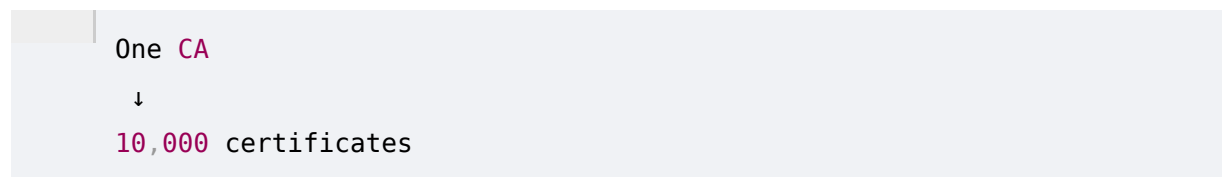


That HSM becomes a potential:



ECDAT should flag this.

Similarly:



creates substantial concentration risk.

44. Shared Cryptographic Dependencies

Example:

```
Application A ┐
Application B ┐
Application C ┌───> OpenSSL
Application D ┐
Application E ┐
```

If OpenSSL requires migration:

```
Migration Impact:
Very High
```

This helps prioritize enterprise-wide upgrades.

45. Attack Path Analysis

ECDAT can eventually identify paths such as:

```
Internet
  ↓
TLS Endpoint
  ↓
Certificate
  ↓
Private Key
  ↓
HSM
  ↓
Critical Application
```

This does not automatically mean the path is exploitable.

It represents:

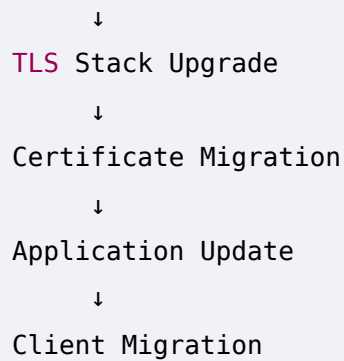
A relationship path relevant to security analysis.

46. Migration Dependency Graph

Migration itself can become a graph.

Example:

```
HSM Upgrade
  ↓
Crypto Library Upgrade
```

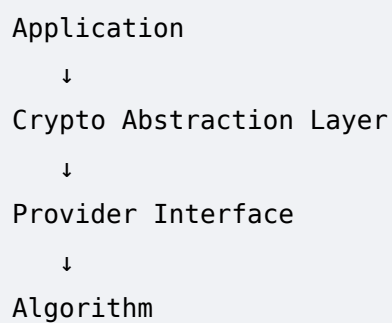


ECDAT can derive the correct sequence.

47. Crypto-Agility Graph

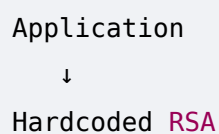
The graph can also model agility.

Example:



This architecture is highly agile.

Compare:



The second has low agility.

48. Knowledge Graph Queries

The graph should support questions such as:

- Which systems use RSA?
- Which critical systems use ECC?
- Which applications depend on OpenSSL?

Which certificates use ECDSA?

Which keys are stored in HSM X?

Which business processes depend on a specific CA?

Which assets have no PQC migration path?

49. Natural Language Queries

This is where AI can create an impressive interface.

A security analyst could ask:

"Show me every critical application using quantum-vulnerable cryptography."

ECDAT translates that into graph queries.

Conceptually:

```
Natural Language
    ↓
Intent Extraction
    ↓
Graph Query Generation
    ↓
Graph Database
    ↓
Results
    ↓
AI Explanation
```

50. Example Query 1

User:

"Which critical systems still use RSA?"

Graph logic:

```
Application
WHERE Criticality = Critical
    ↓
USES
```

↓
RSA

Output:

42 Critical Applications

51. Example Query 2

User:

"What breaks if CA-01 is unavailable?"

ECDAT traverses:

CA-01
↓
Certificates
↓
Applications
↓
Business Processes

Output:

127 applications
14 business processes

with evidence.

52. Example Query 3

User:

"Which cryptographic libraries are the biggest migration bottlenecks?"

Graph analysis:

Library
↓
Number of dependent applications
↓
Risk

↓
Migration complexity

Output:

Library X
Centrality:
Very High

Affected:
2,140 applications

53. Example Query 4

User:

"Which sensitive data is protected by quantum-vulnerable encryption?"

Graph traversal:

Sensitive Data
↓
Protected By
↓
Algorithm
↓
Quantum Vulnerability

This directly addresses the core SIH problem.

54. Example Query 5

User:

"Give me the top five cryptographic migrations we should start this quarter."

ECDAT combines:

Risk
+
Business Criticality
+
Migration Complexity
+

Dependency Centrality

+

Mosca Assessment

and returns a ranked list.

55. Graph + AI

The most powerful architecture combines:

Graph

+

LLM

+

Deterministic Rules

The graph supplies factual relationships.

The LLM interprets and explains them.

Rules enforce constraints.

56. Graph RAG

Traditional RAG:

Question

↓

Vector Search

↓

Documents

↓

LLM

Graph RAG:

Question

↓

Entity Extraction

↓

Graph Traversal

↓

Relevant Nodes

↓

Relevant Documents

↓

LLM

This is particularly suitable for ECDAT.

57. AI Graph Reasoning

Suppose the analyst asks:

"Why is this certificate high risk?"

ECDAT can retrieve:

Certificate

↓

ECDSA

↓

Critical Application

↓

Long-lived Data

↓

High Migration Complexity

The LLM can explain:

The certificate is high priority because it uses a quantum-vulnerable signature mechanism and protects a critical application with a long migration horizon.

The graph provides the evidence.

58. Graph-Based Recommendations

Recommendations can use graph context.

Example:

Algorithm:

ECDSA

Application:

Critical

Dependencies:

HSM

CA
TLS

Migration Complexity:
High

Recommendation:

Hybrid / staged migration

The recommendation is now based on actual enterprise topology.

59. Graph-Based Risk

Risk can also propagate through graph relationships.

Example:

```
Algorithm
  ↓
Library
  ↓
Application
  ↓
Business Process
```

A risk engine can calculate:

```
Direct Risk
+
Dependency Impact
+
Business Impact
```

This creates a much richer enterprise risk model.

60. Temporal Graph

The graph should not only represent:

What exists now?

It should represent:

What existed when?

Example:

```
2026:
RSA

2027:
RSA + ML-KEM

2029:
ML-KEM

2030:
RSA removed
```

This enables migration tracking.

61. Historical Tracking

ECDAT should preserve:

```
First Seen
Last Seen
Previous Value
Current Value
Changed By
Scan ID
```

Example:

```
ECDSA:
First Seen: 2026-08-01
Last Seen: 2026-08-24
Status: Active
```

62. Change Detection

Suppose:

```
Yesterday:
RSA
```

Today:
ML-DSA

ECDAT should detect:

Cryptographic Change Detected

Then recalculate:

Risk
CBOM
Migration Status

63. Versioning

Everything important should be versioned:

Repository
Application
Certificate
Library
Algorithm Configuration
Risk
Recommendation
Migration Plan

This creates an audit trail.

64. Graph Data Quality

Graphs can become messy.

Potential problems:

Duplicate Applications
Duplicate Libraries
Unknown Owners
Conflicting Algorithms
Missing Relationships
Stale Assets

ECDAT therefore needs data-quality controls.

65. Deduplication

Suppose scanners detect:

```
OpenSSL 3.0
OpenSSL/3.0
openssl-3.0.x
```

These may refer to the same dependency.

ECDAT needs canonicalization.

66. Entity Resolution

Different scanners may identify:

```
Payment-Service
payment_service
payment-service-prod
```

as separate assets.

Entity resolution can infer:

```
Same Application
```

but should retain evidence and confidence.

67. Confidence

Graph relationships should have confidence.

Example:

```
Application
|
└─ USES → RSA
      Confidence: 0.99
```

Another:

```
Application
|
└─ USES → ECDSA
      Confidence: 0.61
```

This prevents uncertain relationships from appearing equally authoritative.

68. Provenance

Every graph relationship should answer:

Where did this information come from?

Possible sources:

- Source Code
- Binary
- Certificate
- Container
- Configuration
- Runtime Telemetry
- Scanner
- AI
- Manual Entry

Example:

USES → RSA

Source:
Static Analysis

Evidence:
signing.c:284

69. Graph Database Architecture

A property graph database is a natural fit.

Possible technology:

Neo4j

The graph can model:

- Nodes
- +
- Relationships

+
Properties

and support traversal queries.

Other graph databases could also be considered.

The architecture should avoid making the entire system dependent on a single database implementation too early.

70. Neo4j / Property Graph

Example conceptual model:

```
(:Application)
  -[:USES]->
(:Algorithm)
```

Another:

```
(:Certificate)
  -[:ISSUED_BY]->
(:CA)
```

And:

```
(:Application)
  -[:PROTECTS]->
(😊ataAsset)
```

71. Relational Database Integration

Not everything needs to live in the graph.

Relational databases remain useful for:

```
Users
Organizations
Jobs
Scans
Configuration
Audit Records
Authentication
```

Therefore:

```
PostgreSQL
+
Graph Database
```

may be a strong architecture.

72. Vector Database Integration

Vectors can support semantic retrieval.

For example:

```
Code Embeddings
Documentation Embeddings
Security Guidance
PQC Knowledge
```

Then:

```
Graph
+
Vector Search
+
LLM
```

creates a powerful hybrid knowledge system.

73. Search Architecture

ECDAT could support three search modes:

Exact

```
RSA-2048
```

Semantic

```
Find systems performing digital signing.
```

Graph

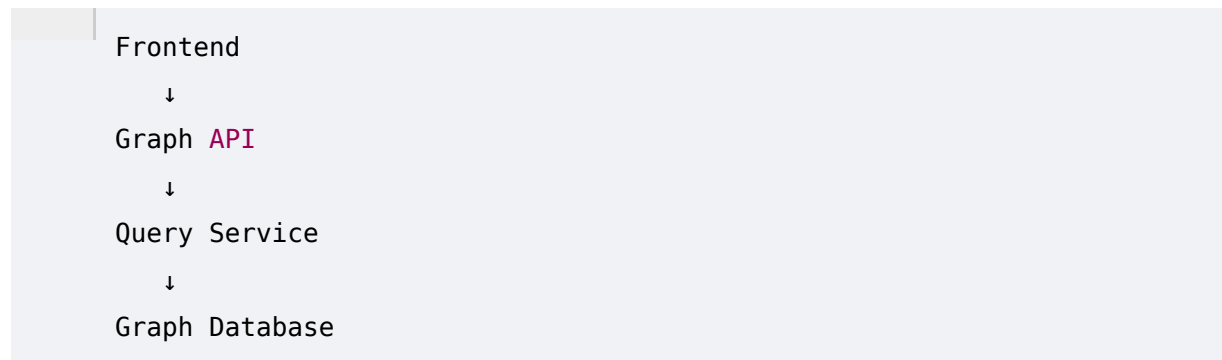
```
What depends on CA-01?
```


All three should converge on the same intelligence layer.

74. Graph API

The frontend should not directly manipulate the graph database.

Instead:

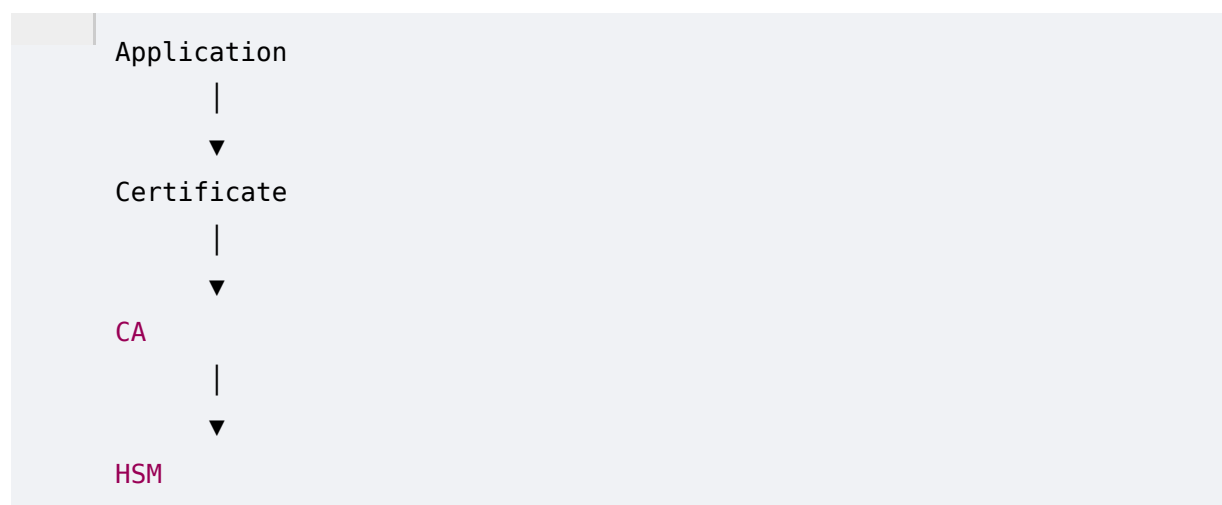


The API can enforce:

- Authentication
 - Authorization
 - Query limits
 - Data filtering
 - Audit logging
-

75. Graph Visualization

A visual graph can show:



Users should be able to:

- Expand nodes
- Filter by type

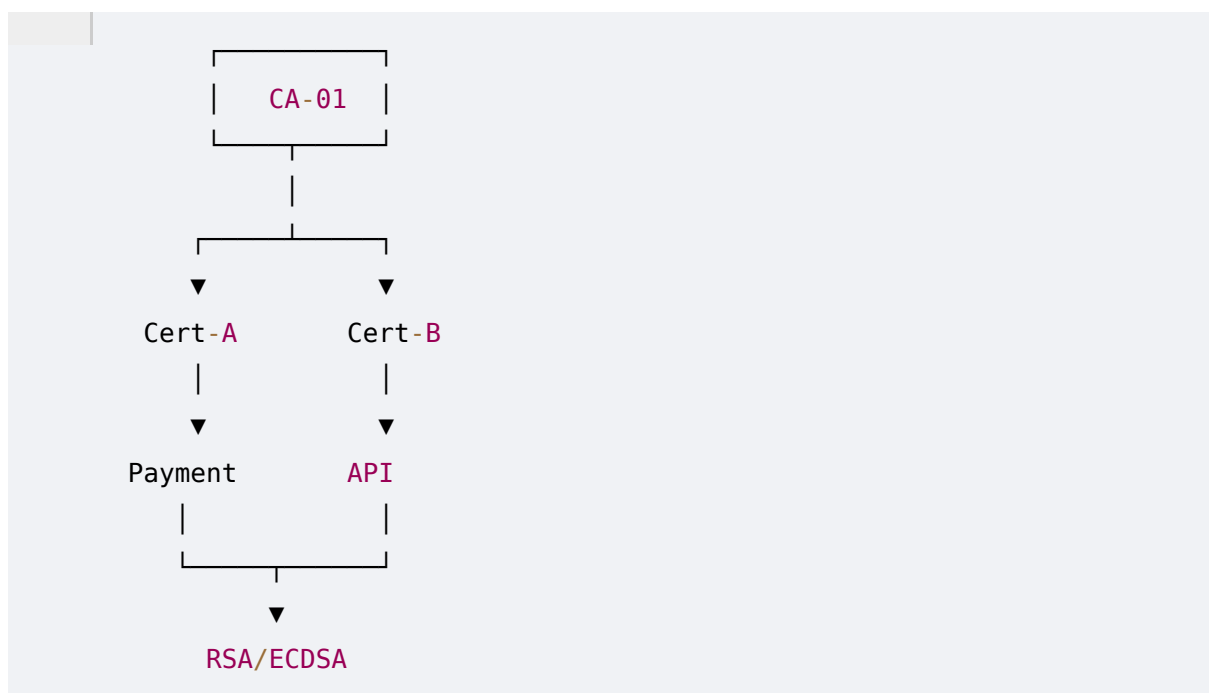
- Filter by risk
- Highlight quantum-vulnerable assets
- Trace dependencies
- View evidence

76. Enterprise Dashboard

A possible dashboard:

CRYPTOGRAPHIC ENTERPRISE MAP	
Applications	4,820
Crypto Assets	28,391
Certificates	74,201
Critical Risks	218
PQC Ready	31%

Then a graph view:



77. Security

The graph itself can contain highly sensitive information.

It may reveal:

- Infrastructure
- Keys
- Certificates
- Dependencies
- Business Processes
- Security Architecture

Therefore the graph must be treated as sensitive security data.

78. Access Control

Different users should see different information.

Example:

Developer

- Own Applications
- Own Findings

Security Analyst

- Enterprise Crypto Findings

CISO

- Enterprise Risk

Executive

- Aggregated Business Impact

79. Sensitive Relationships

Some relationships may be particularly sensitive.

Example:

- HSM
- ↓
- Root CA

This should not necessarily be visible to every user.

ECDAT should support relationship-level access control where required.

80. Graph Threat Model

The knowledge graph itself can become a target.

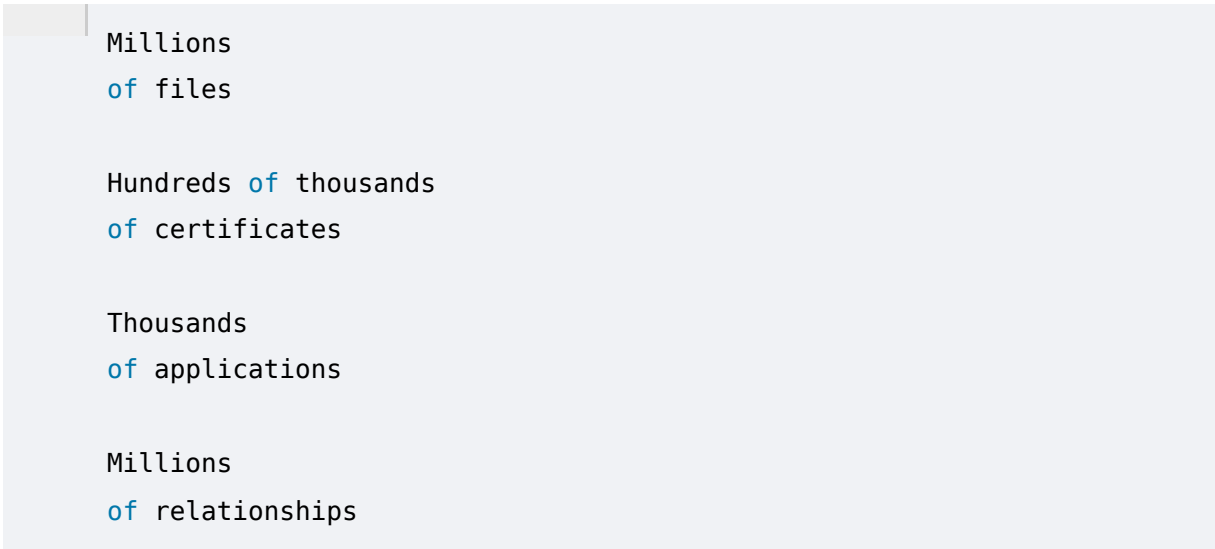
Threats include:

- Unauthorized access
- Graph manipulation
- False relationships
- Data poisoning
- Enumeration
- Credential theft
- Sensitive topology disclosure

Therefore graph integrity is critical.

81. Scalability

Large organizations may have:



Millions
of files

Hundreds of thousands
of certificates

Thousands
of applications

Millions
of relationships

The architecture must support incremental ingestion.

Avoid rebuilding the entire graph after every scan.

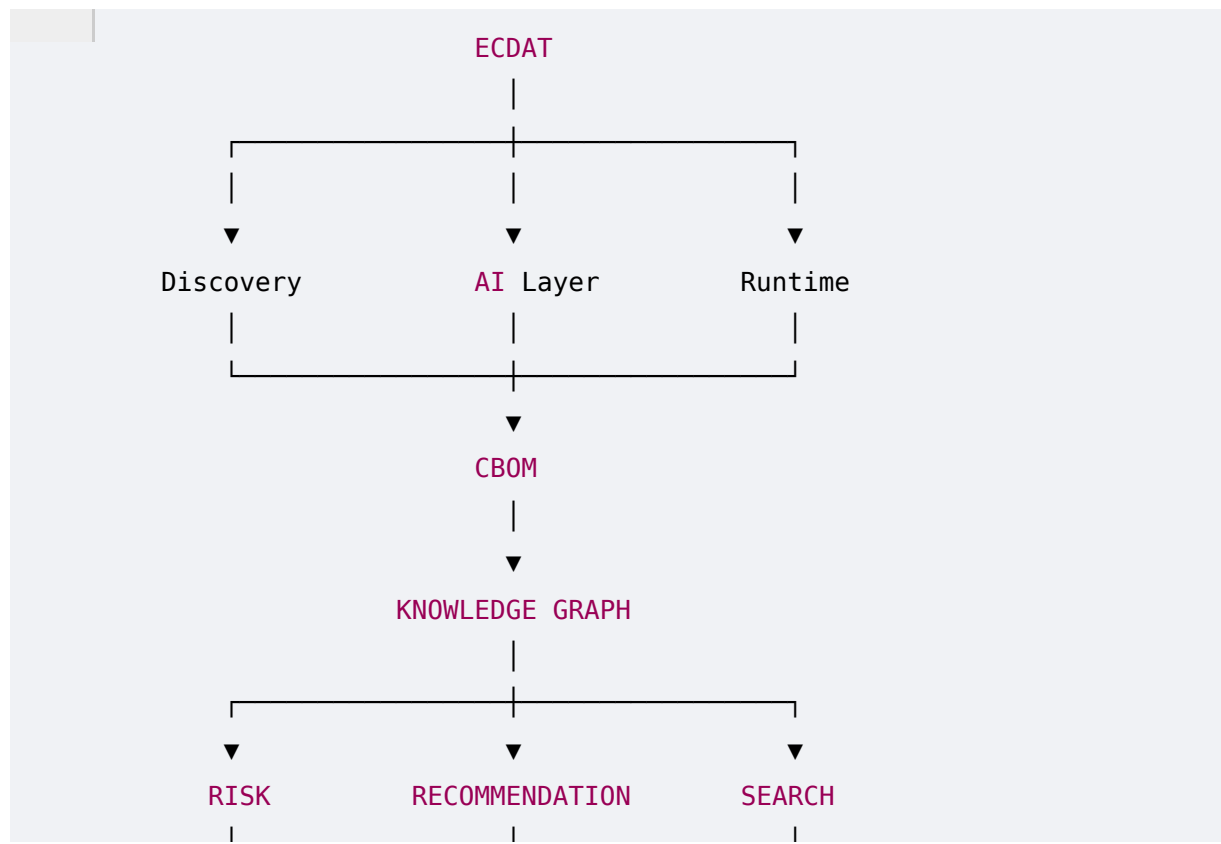
82. Graph Processing Pipeline

A scalable ingestion model:



83. Complete Architecture

The complete intelligence architecture now looks like:



84. Requirements Derived From Phase 9

ECDAT should now include:

Graph

- Property graph
- Node model
- Relationship model
- Evidence
- Provenance
- Confidence
- Temporal history

Intelligence

- Dependency analysis
- Blast radius
- Centrality
- Risk propagation
- PKI mapping
- Business mapping

Search

- Exact search
- Semantic search
- Graph search
- Natural-language queries

AI

- Graph RAG
- Natural-language-to-query
- Graph explanation
- Evidence-grounded reasoning

Visualization

- Enterprise graph
- Dependency explorer
- Risk overlay
- Migration graph

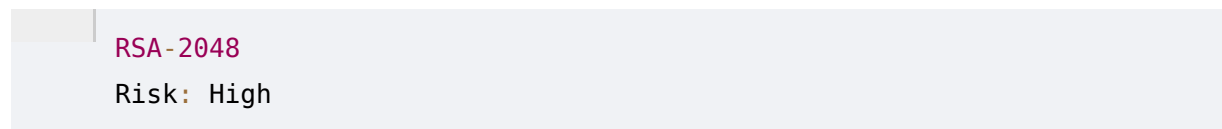
Governance

- Access control
 - Audit
 - Data quality
 - Entity resolution
 - Versioning
-

85. Phase 9 Summary

Phase 9 fundamentally changes the nature of ECDAT.

Without a graph:



With a graph:



The second is an actual **enterprise intelligence model**.

86. The Most Important Insight

ECDAT should not think in terms of:

"Cryptographic assets."

It should think in terms of:

Cryptographic relationships.

Because the actual security question is rarely:

"Does RSA exist?"

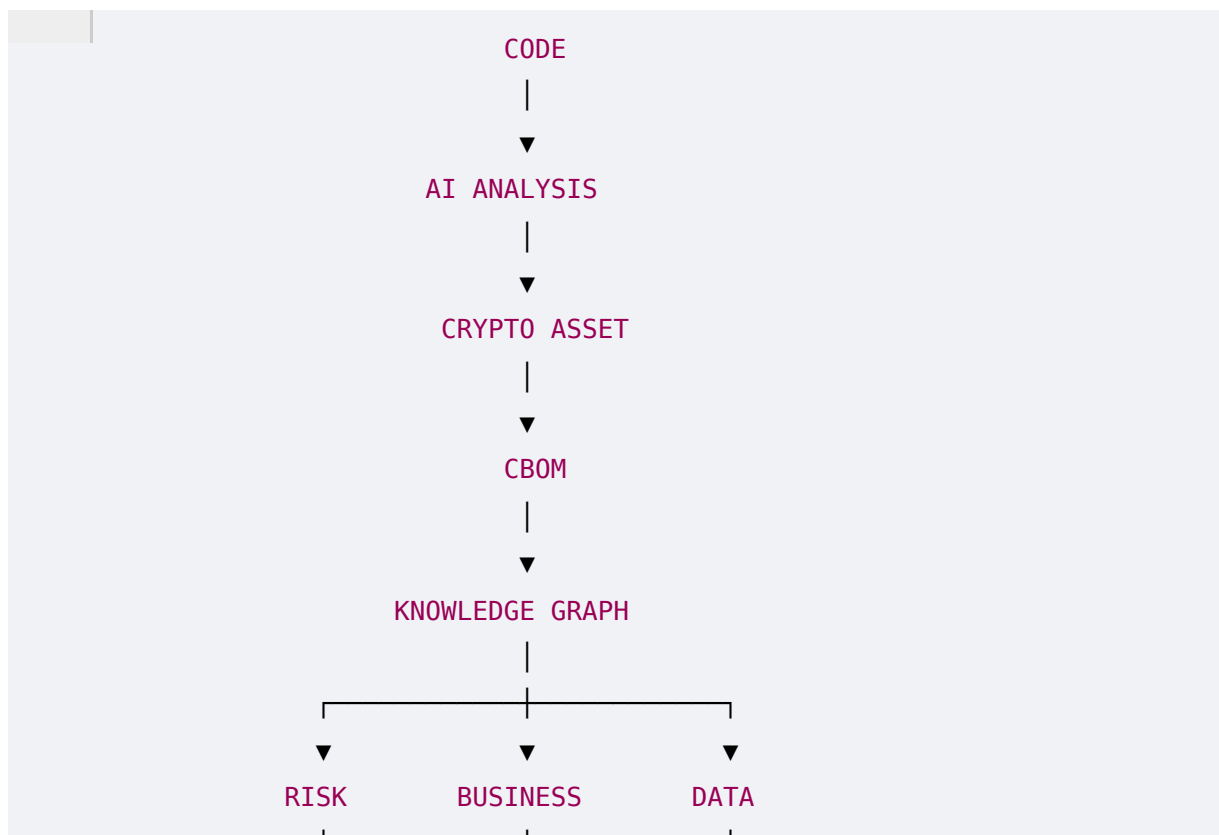
It is:

"Where is RSA used, what does it protect, who depends on it, how critical is it, and what happens if we need to replace it?"

That requires a graph.

87. The ECDAT Intelligence Chain

After Phase 9, the architecture can now be described as:



This is becoming a full **cryptographic intelligence platform**, rather than simply a scanner.

PHASE 10 PREVIEW — ENTERPRISE SCANNING ENGINE & MULTI-SOURCE DISCOVERY FABRIC

The graph tells us **how everything is connected**.

But now we need to build the machinery that continuously feeds it.

Phase 10 will cover the actual enterprise scanning architecture:

- GitHub/GitLab repository scanning
- Source-code scanning
- Binary scanning
- Container scanning
- Package scanning
- Dependency scanning
- Certificate discovery
- Key metadata discovery
- TLS endpoint scanning
- Network discovery
- Cloud discovery
- Kubernetes discovery
- HSM/KMS discovery
- Configuration scanning
- SBOM integration
- Runtime telemetry
- Endpoint agents
- CI/CD integration
- Scheduled scanning
- Incremental scanning
- Event-driven scanning
- Scanner orchestration
- Job queues
- Distributed workers
- Scan prioritization
- Air-gapped environments
- Offline scanning
- Credential management
- Secure connectors
- Evidence normalization
- Deduplication

- Scan coverage metrics
- Scanner health
- Failure recovery
- Enterprise-scale architecture

The central question will be:

How does ECDAT actually discover cryptography across an entire enterprise, continuously and reliably?

That is where we move from **intelligence architecture** into the **actual scanning infrastructure**.

Phase 9 complete.